The Protein Guide

One number. Everything else follows it.

Where your protein comes from, how much of it you need, and how to land it without weighing a thing.

01 YOUR NUMBER

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Protein is the gatekeeper.

Fat loss comes from a modest calorie deficit. Protein is what makes sure the weight you lose is fat and not the muscle you spent time building and want to keep. It keeps you full, it protects the muscle that supports your joints and burns your calories, and it takes the edge off cravings before they start.

When people are told to eat more protein and nothing else is restricted, they tend to eat several hundred calories less a day without trying. You are not managing calories. You are managing one number, and the calories look after themselves.

01

Your number

Your target is **1.5g of protein per kilo of bodyweight.**

YOUR BODYWEIGHT	THE FLOOR	YOUR TARGET
60kg	70g	90g
70kg	85g	105g
80kg	95g	120g
90kg	110g	135g
100kg	120g	150g
110kg	130g	165g
120kg	145g	180g

The floor is 1.2g per kilo. On a travel day, a mad day, a day that got away from you, this is the line you do not go below. It is what protects your muscle while you lean down.

The target is 1.5g per kilo. The closer you get to it, the more you get out of it. Fuller for longer, more muscle held onto, better results when you are losing body fat.

> IF THE NUMBER LOOKS BIG
>
> The heavier you are, the bigger the number, and on day one it can look impossible. Start at the floor and build toward the target across a number of weeks. The number comes down as you lose weight.

02

Where it comes from

Approximate protein in the portions given. Add them up across the day until you reach your number. Meat, fish and tofu are raw weights. Lentils, beans and edamame are cooked or drained.

MEAT, FISH, EGGS AND DAIRY

FOOD	PORTION	PROTEIN
Chicken breast	1 medium fillet, about 165g	38g
Chicken breast	1 large fillet, about 220g	50g
Turkey breast	1 medium fillet, about 170g	40g
Beef mince, 5% fat	250g, half a pack	50g
Sirloin steak	200g	42g
Hake or cod	1 large fillet, about 220g	40g
Salmon	1 fillet, about 150g	30g
Tuna, tinned in water	1 tin, drained	28g
Eggs	4 large eggs	26g
Greek yogurt, 0% fat	200g, about half a tub	20g
Cottage cheese	200g	22g
Milk	1 pint	20g
Whey protein	1 heaped scoop, about 30g	24g

PLANT-BASED

These carry less per portion, so it often takes two together to land one full anchor. Chickpeas with lentils, or tofu with edamame.

FOOD	PORTION	PROTEIN
Firm tofu	200g, about half a block	30g
Tempeh	150g	28g
Pea or soy protein	1 heaped scoop, about 30g	24g
Red lentils	Large bowl, 250g cooked	22g
Edamame	150g, shelled	17g
Chickpeas or butter beans	1 tin, drained	16g

03

Measuring without an app

Your hand is a really useful tool.

HAND MEASURE	FOOD	PROTEIN
One palm, about 120g cooked	Chicken, turkey, lean beef, white fish	30-35g
One palm, about 120g cooked	Salmon or tuna steak	28-32g
Three large eggs	Whole eggs	19g
One fist, about 200g	Greek yogurt or cottage cheese	20-22g
One tin, drained	Tinned tuna or sardines	25-28g
One heaped scoop	Protein powder in water or milk	24-27g

> IF YOU ONLY CHANGE ONE THING
>
> Front-load it. Get 30-40g in before ten in the morning and the rest of the day stops being a chase. Most guys who miss their number miss it because they started at lunchtime.

04

How the day looks

Two big meals or six small ones, it makes no difference to the result. What matters is that the day adds up to your number. Start here and change it to fit your schedule.

Breakfast Options, aim 40g

Three eggs with smoked salmon. Greek yogurt with berries, nuts and a scoop of whey. A three-egg omelette with cheese and ham plus a glass of milk. Eggs on their own will not get you there, so pair them with something.

Lunch Options, aim 40-50g

A palm-plus of protein with vegetables and a moderate carbohydrate. Rotisserie chicken, turkey breast slices, fish, steak, or a big tuna or egg salad.

Late Afternoon Options, aim 20-30g

This is the danger window in a long working day, and it is where most days come apart. Have the answer ready before you need it: Greek yogurt, cottage cheese, three boiled eggs, a shake, beef jerky.

Dinner, aim 40-50g

Protein first, then vegetables, then the carbohydrate. If you trained today, this is the meal that gets the bigger carbohydrate portion.

DO NOT CHASE IT PERFECTLY

Some days you will sail past the number and some days you will be miles off. What you are really doing is practising, and the more you do it the more automatic it gets. This is about practice, not perfection.

05

Out, away and on the move

In a restaurant

- Order the protein first and build the meal around it. That is your anchor and the rest is decoration.
- Your palm is roughly 30 to 35g. Handy when there is no label on anything.
- Swap the chips for extra vegetables, salad or a baked potato. Just ask.
- Order first if you can. It is a lot harder to hold the line after three other people have ordered chips.

Set your environment up to create the habits

- **Kitchen.** An air fryer, a blender, and glass Tupperware. Cook four chicken fillets at a time, not one.
- **Car.** A cooler bag in the boot of the car and day to day add yogurt, slices of turkey breast, beef jerky, ready-made protein shake, home-made wraps/sandwiches.
- **Travel.** Go to the airport full. That single decision does more than anything you will buy once you are inside it.

Supplements

Whey protein is the single most useful one you can add. Twenty-five grams in thirty seconds, and it turns the afternoon window from a problem into a non-event. Protein milk from any shop does the same job. Use shakes and bars to hit your number, not to feed a sweet tooth.

Protein bars carry a fair chunk of calories and are closer to a chocolate bar, aim to use them when you are stuck, not for a chocolate hit!

And on the kidneys, since it tends to come up, in healthy people, higher protein has not been shown to cause harm. If you have a diagnosed kidney condition, talk to your doctor first.

THE THUNGRY TEST

Am I actually hungry, or am I thirsty? Drink 250 to 500ml and wait twenty minutes. If the hunger persists, eat protein first. If it fades, you were thirsty. Mild dehydration is one of the most common reasons we snack when we did not need to.

Gary Brown Chartered Physiotherapist | Coach | gary@garybrownhere.com